



Funded by the New Jersey
Department of Labor and
Workforce Development

INFORMATION SESSION FOR WORKFIRST NEW JERSEY STAFF

Digital Literacy Training

Computer, AI and job search training at no cost for adults on TANF or SNAP.
First class starts the first week of October.

Presented by Awais Qazi, Program Coordinator, with Shazia Qazi, Program Director



Prepared for Hunterdon County Educational Services Commission, WorkFirst New Jersey · Tuesday, September 22, 2026

The funding for this initiative is being provided by the New Jersey Department of Labor and Workforce Development.

WHAT IT IS

A short, hands-on program that ends in a credential and a job search

Mercer Med Tech is a state-licensed career school in Lawrenceville. The New Jersey Department of Labor selected us as one of six grantees statewide to bring digital skills training to WorkFirst NJ participants in the Central Region.

No cost

Grant funded, no fees for the participant

5 to 6 weeks

Small groups, online with scheduled in-person office hours

7 counties

Hunterdon, Somerset, Mercer, Middlesex, Monmouth, Ocean, Union

EN / ES

Staff who speak English and Spanish

Early October

First group starts; new groups every 5 to 6 weeks

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WHO QUALIFIES

Four things to check

 **Lives in New Jersey, 18 or older**
Age 18 or older on the first day of training.

 **Receives TANF or SNAP today**
Benefits through WorkFirst New Jersey.

 **Lives in one of the seven counties**
Hunterdon and Somerset residents are welcome; we serve the whole Central Region.

 **Ready to train and look for work**
Can attend class and work with us on the job search.



No referral form and no education requirement: people without a diploma and people with a degree are both welcome. We confirm each person's eligibility with your office before they start, so the caseworker does not have to do that part.

WHAT PARTICIPANTS LEARN

Seven skill areas, all hands-on, at the level each person needs

Computer basics

Mouse, keyboard, files and folders, settings.

Internet, email and online meetings

Searching, browsing safely, professional email.

Microsoft Office and Google Workspace

Documents, spreadsheets and slides in both tool sets.

Online safety

Passwords, phishing, scams, protecting accounts.

AI literacy

Using AI tools at work, and where they get things wrong.

Money management

Banking on a phone, budgeting, spotting a scam.

Getting ready for work

Resume, applying online, interview practice.

BEFORE DAY ONE

A short skills check, so someone who already knows the basics is not made to sit through them.

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THE TRAINING PATHWAY

Foundations first, then credentials that count

1

Foundations

60 hours with Mercer Med
Tech

Computer operation, files,
internet and email,
productivity software,
cybersecurity basics. Baseline
check, progress checks and a
final capstone.

2

NJIT credentials

32 hours, online

AI Literacy Microcredential, 20
hours, plus the Digital Literacy
Microcredential, 12 hours.
These are the ETPL-listed
credentials NJDOL counts.

3

Enrichment

20 hours, live online

Emerging technologies (cloud,
data, automation) and financial
literacy (budgeting, credit,
digital payments, fraud),
taught by specialist
instructors.

4

Advanced pathway

Case by case

Further ETPL training for
people who want more
credentials or who are already
past the foundations; NJDOL
approves each placement.

About 110 hours in all over 5 to 6 weeks. Someone who already has the basics can test past the foundations and start with the credentials.

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WHAT THEY LEAVE WITH

Proof of skills, a plan, and someone still in their corner

An industry-recognized credential

Including the NJIT **AI Literacy Microcredential**, completed online and on New Jersey's Eligible Training Provider List, plus Mercer Med Tech's certificate of completion.

A resume and interview practice

A finished resume, practice interviews with us first, and a job search plan they can keep going on their own.

Career services that continue

Job search coaching starts during training, not after it: one-to-one help, introductions to employers, and check-ins at 30, 60 and 90 days after they start a job.

Every participant works toward at least one credential that NJDOL recognizes. Training time and the credential can count toward a person's work activity plan; we will document attendance for your records.

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HOW IT WORKS FOR THE PEOPLE YOU REFER

Four steps, in order

1

Send them our way

Give them the sign-up link: mercermedtech.com/digital-literacy/sign-up. No paperwork from you; we take it from there.

2

We confirm eligibility

We check TANF or SNAP status with your office. This is on us, not the future student or the caseworker.

3

Skills check and a plan, in week one

A short assessment sets the starting level. Together we write an Individual Employment Plan within seven days, and flag any need for transportation, a device or other support right there.

4

Training, online or in person

About 5 to 6 weeks. Every class is available online. In-person support is offered at the Lawrenceville campus during scheduled office hours.

Participants who live in Hunterdon or Somerset also need an AOSOS number from the Greater Raritan One-Stop. We request those in batches from the NJDOL Employment Services office at the Greater Raritan One-Stop, so it does not fall to you.

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WHO YOUR TEAM WILL WORK WITH

Who your team will work with

Awais Qazi, Onboarding and Recruitment Specialist

Your day-to-day contact for referrals: eligibility, documents, enrollment and orientation, and the weekly enrollment report to your office. awais.a.qazi@gmail.com

Shazia Qazi, Career Services Advisor

Writes the Individual Employment Plan with each person, coaches the job search, works the employer relationships, and does the 30, 60 and 90 day follow-ups.

IT and Computer Fundamentals Instructor

Teaches the 60-hour foundations with hands-on labs, online and during campus office hours; specialist instructors join for the enrichment modules. Being staffed for the October start.

Program leadership

Shazia Qazi, Program Director, and Awais Qazi, Program Coordinator, also handle partner questions, reporting to NJDOL, and anything that needs a decision.

Groups are 10 to 12 people, so each person gets time with the instructor and the advisor. A second advisor is added when the caseload calls for it.

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What we ask of you, and what you get back

We ask

- Tell future students about the program and share the sign-up link
- Let us know who you have sent, so we can watch for them
- Help us confirm TANF or SNAP status when we ask
- Tell us your own intake steps, and we will work to them

You get

- A weekly email listing who enrolled, in your format if you have one
- Attendance and completion records for work activity reporting; we report enrollment, credentials and placements to NJDOL monthly, by county
- Participant information kept confidential and shared only as the grant requires
- A ready-made outreach kit: posts, a flyer and an email you can forward, in English and Spanish, at mercermedtech.com/partners/hunterdon-county
- Two people who answer: Awais Qazi for referrals and enrollment, awais.a.qazi@gmail.com; Shazia Qazi for career services and the program, 609-712-5499

BARRIERS WE CAN HELP WITH, CASE BY CASE

Built to be accessible: online, in person, or both

You told us transportation is a real issue for many of the people you work with. The whole curriculum is delivered online, so nobody has to travel to take part. Staff are available in person at the Lawrenceville campus during scheduled office hours for anyone who learns better in a room with an instructor; the schedule is shared with students when the program starts. The NJIT AI Literacy credential is completed online as well.



Travel help for anyone who chooses to come in



A laptop and internet access at home



Exam, credential and ID fees



Clothes for interviews



Virtual orientations for partner staff

Each support is decided case by case from the need written into the person's plan, provided before it is needed rather than reimbursed after, and documented for NJDOL. Childcare is not a standard support, but it can be accommodated case by case.

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THE QUESTIONS YOUR TEAM HAS ASKED

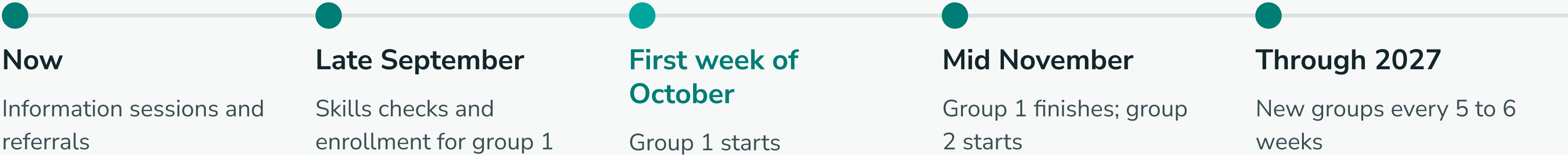
Straight answers

Question	Answer
Is there a virtual option?	Yes. The full curriculum runs online. In-person support is available at the Lawrenceville campus during scheduled office hours, shared with students at the start, with travel help for those who need it.
Do you need a referral form?	No. The online sign-up form is enough: mercermedtech.com/digital-literacy/sign-up . If your office has its own form, we will use it.
Who confirms eligibility?	We do, with your office, before anyone starts. TANF or SNAP only.
How will we know who enrolled?	A weekly email to your office listing enrollments and, later, completions and job placements.
What do they leave with?	An industry-recognized credential, including the NJIT AI Literacy Microcredential (completed online), a resume, and ongoing career services.
When does it start?	The first group starts the first week of October. New groups begin every 5 to 6 weeks.

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TIMING

Where we are, and what comes next



Groups of 10 to 12, about ten groups over the grant. Our goal is 100 people served across the Central Region, with at least eight in ten earning a credential and six in ten placed in work. The people you refer can be in the first group.

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LET US GET STARTED

Send us your first future students this week

PROGRAM DIRECTOR · CAREER
SERVICES ADVISOR

Shazia Qazi

609-712-5499 (staff line)
mercermedtech@gmail.com

PROGRAM COORDINATOR · ONBOARDING
AND RECRUITMENT

Awais Qazi

awais.a.qazi@gmail.com

CAMPUS

168 Franklin Corner Rd, Bldg 2, Suite
140

Lawrenceville, NJ 08648

mercermedtech.com/digital-literacy/sign-up

Outreach kit:

mercermedtech.com/partners/hunterdon-county

Mercer Med Tech is a state-approved private vocational school licensed by the New Jersey Department of Labor and Workforce Development and is on New Jersey's Eligible Training Provider List.

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